

Area of Shapes: Trapezoid, Rectangle & Triangle

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Standard: CCSS.MATH.CONTENT.6.G.A.1 — Find the area of right triangles, other triangles, special quadrilaterals, and polygons by composing into rectangles or decomposing into triangles and other shapes.



Mr. Kenny's 6 Steps (use them every time!)

1. **IDENTIFY** what's given and what's asked (read the **LAST line first!**)
2. **DRAW** the shape — label everything
3. **PICK** a formula — which one fits this shape?
4. **PLUG IN** the numbers (substitute carefully)
5. **CALCULATE** step by step (show every multiply and add)
6. **FINAL** answer — don't forget **units!**

Part A — Basic Area Practice

Directions: Use all 6 steps for each problem. Show every line of work — no shortcuts. Don't forget your units!

Problem #1

A trapezoid has a top base of 0.6 in, a bottom base of 2 in, and a height of 1.7 in. Find the area of the trapezoid.

Step 1 — IDENTIFY (read the *LAST* line first!)

Given: _____

Find: _____

Step 2 — DRAW the shape (label every side and the height)



draw & label here

Step 3 — PICK a formula (which one fits this shape?)

Formula: $A =$ _____

Step 4 — PLUG IN (substitute the numbers)

Step 5 — CALCULATE (show every multiply and add)

_____ = _____
_____ = _____
_____ = _____

Step 6 — FINAL ANSWER (don't forget units!)

$A =$

Problem #2

A rectangle has a width of 2.3 ft and a length of 5 ft. Find the area of the rectangle.

Step 1 — IDENTIFY (*read the LAST line first!*)

Given: _____

Find: _____

Step 2 — DRAW the shape (*label every side*)



draw & label here

Step 3 — PICK a formula

Formula: $A =$ _____

Step 4 — PLUG IN

Step 5 — CALCULATE

_____ = _____
_____ = _____

Step 6 — FINAL ANSWER (*units!*)

$A =$

Problem #3

A trapezoid has a top base of 4.6 m, a bottom base of 1.6 m, and a height of 3.4 m. Find the area of the trapezoid.

Step 1 — IDENTIFY

Given: _____

Find: _____

Step 2 — DRAW the shape

draw & label here

Step 3 — PICK a formula

Formula: $A =$ _____

Step 4 — PLUG IN

Step 5 — CALCULATE

	$=$	
	$=$	
	$=$	

Step 6 — FINAL ANSWER

$A =$

Problem #4

A triangle has a base of 4 m and a height of 2.7 m. Find the area of the triangle.

Step 1 — IDENTIFY

Given: _____

Find: _____

Step 2 — DRAW the shape (remember: base and height are perpendicular!)



draw & label here

Step 3 — PICK a formula

Formula: $A =$ _____

Step 4 — PLUG IN

Step 5 — CALCULATE

_____ = _____
_____ = _____

Step 6 — FINAL ANSWER

$A =$

Part B — Apply Your Skills

Directions: *This one needs you to work backwards. You're given the area — find the bases. Use*

all 6 steps. Take your time and write every line.

Problem #5 (application)

A trapezoidal garden has an area of 96 cm^2 and a height of 6 cm . The longer base is 4 cm longer than the shorter base. Find the lengths of **both** bases (b_1 and b_2).

Step 1 — IDENTIFY (read the *LAST* line first — what do you need to find?)

Given: _____

Find: _____

Step 2 — DRAW the shape (label the shorter base b_1 , the longer base $b_2 = b_1 + 4$, and the height)



draw & label here

Step 3 — PICK a formula

Formula: $A =$ _____

Step 4 — PLUG IN (substitute A , h , and write b_2 in terms of b_1)

Step 5 — CALCULATE / SOLVE (solve for b_1 , one step at a time)

_____ = _____

_____ = _____

_____ = _____

$b_1 =$ _____

Step 6 — FINAL ANSWER (both bases, with units!)

$b_1 =$ (shorter base)

$b_2 =$ (longer base)